

Harin Lee

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POSITIONS

University of Cambridge, UK

Oct 2025 — Junior Research Fellow at King's College on the topic of 'Rhythm'
Feb 2026 — Co-director of Music Cognition & Culture (MCC) group, Centre for Music and Science

Oct 2020 — Sep 2025 **Max Planck Institute for Human Cognitive and Brain Sciences (MPI CBS)**, Germany
PhD in Cognitive Science. Thesis titled "Global Music Culture" supervised by Dr Marc Schönwiesner & Dr Nori Jacoby — Summa Cum Laude

Oct 2020 — Sep 2025 **International Max Planck Research Schools Fellowship (IMPRS NeuroCom)**, Germany
Full-funding by the Max Planck Society on a competitive basis

Dec 2020 — Sep 2025 **Max Planck Institute for Empirical Aesthetics (MPIEA)**, Germany
Visiting Researcher at the *Computational Auditory Perception* group led by Dr Nori Jacoby

EDUCATION

* Gap between MSc and PhD is due to serving two year compulsory Korean military duty

Goldsmiths College, University of London, UK

Oct 2017 — Oct 2018 MSc Music, Mind and Brain — Distinction
Oct 2013 — Sep 2017 BMus Popular Music — First Class

Other TSE Summer School in Quantitative Social Sciences (2024), Diverse Intelligence Summer Institute Fellow (2022), Neuromatch Academy Summer School (2020)

PUBLICATIONS

*Joint First Authorship; †Joint Senior/Last Authorship

Ref. Journal Articles &
Archival Conf. Proc

— 2026 —

(Accepted) Anglada-Tort, M. & **Lee, H.** (2026). Computing Aesthetic Taste. (2026). **Current Opinions in Psychology**.

(Accepted) Botticelli-Wells, W. T., Anglada-Tort, M., Çelen, E., Far, R., **Lee, H.**, Harrison, P. M. C. & Jacoby, N. (2026). GlobalTap: Globally Diverse Beat Tracking Benchmark via Crowdsourced Tapping. *Proceedings of the International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR)*.

Sguerra, B., Epure, E., **Lee, H.**, & Moussallam, M. (2026). A Study of Biases in LLM-Generated Musical Taste Profiles for Recommendation. **ACM Transactions on Recommender Systems**.
<https://doi.org/10.1145/3815194>

Lee, H., Polak, R., Anglada-Tort, M., Schönwiesner, M., Park, M., & Jacoby, N. (2026). Do Melody and Rhythm Coevolve? *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*, 48(0). <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/5nd83609>

van Rijn, P., Sun, Y., **Lee, H.**, Marjeh, R., Sucholutsky, I., Lanzarini, F., André, E., & Jacoby, N. (2026). One test, many tongues: Surveying language proficiency across the globe. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*, 123(13), e2420179123.
<https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2420179123>

— 2025 —

Marjeh, R., van Rijn, P., Sucholutsky, I., **Lee, H.**, Jacoby, N., & Griffiths, T. L. (2025). Characterizing the Large-Scale Structure of Multimodal Semantic Networks. *Cognitive Science*, 49(10), e70131. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cogs.70131>

Lee, H., Jacoby, N., Hennequin, R.[†], & Moussallam, M.[†] (2025). Mechanisms of cultural diversity in urban populations. *Nature Communications*, 16(1), 5192. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-025-60538-2>

Lee, H., Çelen, E., Harrison, P. M. C., Anglada-Tort, M., van Rijn, P., Park, M., Schönwiesner, M., & Jacoby, N. (2025). GlobalMood: A cross-cultural benchmark for music emotion recognition. *Proceedings of the International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR)*. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2505.09539>. — Best Student Paper Award.

Lee, H., Van Geert, E., Çelen, E., Marjeh, R., van Rijn, P., Park, M., & Jacoby, N. (2025). Visual and Auditory Aesthetic Preferences Across Cultures. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2502.14439>

Çelen, E., van Rijn, P., **Lee, H.**[†], & Jacoby, N.[†] (2025). Are Expressions for Music Emotions the Same Across Cultures? *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2502.08744>

Sguerra, B., Epure, E. V., **Lee, H.**, & Moussallam, M. (2025). Biases in LLM-Generated Musical Taste Profiles for Recommendation. *Proceedings of the ACM Conference on Recommender Systems (RecSys)*. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3705328.3748030>

— 2024 —

Marjeh, R., van Rijn, P., Sucholutsky, I., **Lee, H.**, Griffiths, T. L., & Jacoby, N. (2024). A Rational Analysis of the Speech-to-Song Illusion. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*. <https://doi.org/10.48550/arXiv.2402.06992>

Marjeh, R.^{*}, Harrison, P. M. C.^{*}, **Lee, H.**, Deligiannaki, F., Jacoby, N. (2024). Timbral effects on consonance disentangle psychoacoustic mechanisms and suggest perceptual origins for musical scales. *Nature Communications*, 15(1), 1482. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-024-45812-z>

— 2023 —

Lee, H., Hennequin, H., & Moussallam, M. (2023). Understanding individual and collective diversity of cultural consumption through large-scale of music listening events. *Proceedings of the Computational Humanities Research Conference (CHR)*. — Best Paper Award. <https://ceur-ws.org/Vol-3558/paper3539.pdf>

Anglada-Tort, M., **Lee, H.**, Krause, A. E., & North, A. C. (2023). Here comes the sun: Music features of popular songs reflect prevailing weather conditions. *Royal Society Open Science*, 10(5), 221443. <https://doi.org/10.1098/rsos.221443>

van Rijn, P., Sun, Y., **Lee, H.**, Marjeh, R., Sucholutsky, I., Lanza-rini, F., André, E., & Jacoby, N. (2023). Around the world in 60 words: A generative vocabulary test for online research. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2023.02.070>

Anglada-Tort, M., Harrison, P. M. C., **Lee, H.**, & Jacoby, N. (2023). Large-scale iterated singing experiments reveal oral transmission mechanisms underlying music evolution. *Current Biology*, 0(0). <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cub.2023.02.070>

Marjeh, R.^{*}, van Rijn, P.^{*}, Sucholutsky, I.^{*}, Sumers, T., **Lee, H.**, Griffiths, T. L.[†], & Jacoby, N.[†] (2023). Words are all you need? Language as an approximation for human similarity judgments. *Proceedings of the International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*. <https://openreview.net/forum?id=O-G91-4cMdv>

— 2022 —

van Rijn, P.* , **Lee, H.*** , & Jacoby, N. (2022). Bridging the prosody GAP: Genetic Algorithm with People to efficiently sample emotional prosody. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci)*. <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/59q714w6>

— 2021 —

Lee, H., Höger, F., Schoenwiesner, M., Park, M., & Jacoby, N. (2021). Cross-cultural mood perception in pop songs and its alignment with mood detection algorithms. *Proceedings of the International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR)*, 366–373. — Finalist for Best Paper Award. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.5625680>

— 2020 —

Lee, H., Launay, J., & Stewart, L. (2020). Signals through music and dance: Perceived social bonds and formidability on collective movement. *Acta Psychologica*, 208, 103093. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2020.103093>

Lee, H., & Müllensiefen, D. (2020). The Timbre Perception Test (TPT): A new interactive musical assessment tool to measure timbre perception ability. *Attention, Perception, and Psychophysics*, 82(7), 3658–3675. <https://doi.org/10.3758/s13414-020-02058-3>

In Review & Preprints **Lee, H.***, Anglada-Tort, M.* , Sobchuk, O., van Rijn, P., Schönwiesner, M., Tchernichovski, O.†, Park, M.†, & Jacoby, N.† Unsettled Times: Music Discovery Reveals Divergent Cultural Responses to War. *In Review*, preprint at <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/7b98u>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCES & ACTIVITIES

Research Expedition **Field Experiments**, Bolivia

Jul 2025 Conducted experiments across small-scale society Tsimané villages in the Bolivian Amazon — video documentation: <https://youtu.be/JbWHa7KTeBg>

Research Intern **Deezer Research**, Paris, France

May 2023 — Nov 2023 Self-led project on understanding diversity in music listening.

Program Committee **Chair in Music** for ISMIR 2025

External Reviewer Journals: *Topics in Cognitive Science*; *Scientific Reports*; *IEEE Transactions on Affective Computing*; *Transactions of the International Society of Music Information Retrieval (TISMIR)*; *International Society of Music Information Retrieval (ISMIR)*; *Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*; *Evolutionary Human Sciences*; *Psychology of Music*; *Music & Science*

Co-founder **aiar collective**, bridging neuroscience with music performance — www.aiarcollective.com

AWARDS & HONOURS

- 2025 **Best Student Paper Award**, Intl. Soc. of Music Information Retrieval (ISMIR)
- 2025 **Best Student Paper Award**, Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC)
- 2025 **Junior Research Fellowship**, King's College, University of Cambridge — 4 yrs stipend
- 2024 **Best Student Presentation Award**, Cultural Evolution Society Conf. (CES)
- 2023 **Best Paper Award**, Computational Humanities Research Conf. (CHR)
- 2023 **Nomination for Young Researcher Award**, Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC)
- 2023 **Travel Grant**, Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC) — \$500
- 2022 **Scientific Research Fellow**, Diverse Intelligence Summer Institute (DISI) — \$3,000
- 2022 **Art Grant** — Interactive Music Performance Using EEG, Leipzig City Council — €9,500
- 2021 **Nomination for Best Student Paper**, Intl. Soc. of Music Information Retrieval (ISMIR)
- 2021 **Nomination for Best Student Paper**, Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC)
- 2017 **Academic Excellence Scholarship**, Goldsmiths College — £3,000
- 2016 **Joe Brown Memorial Scholarship**, Music Department, Goldsmiths College — £500

INVITED TALKS & WORKSHOPS

- 2026 **CHIA Annual Conference, University of Cambridge, UK**
Panel for 'Intergenerational Perspectives on AI in a Changing World'
- 2026 **University of Oxford, UK**
Music, Language, and Mind Workshop hosted by Asifa Majid and Tim Coombes
- 2026 **NLP4MusA Workshop, EACL 2026, Morocco**
Understanding music in the age of big data
- 2026 **MMB & PANC Talk Series, Goldsmiths, University of London, UK**
Aesthetic taste around the world
- 2026 **Spiers Lab, UCL, US**
Computing cultural taste
- 2026 **CAVA, Adobe Research, US**
Computing cultural taste
- 2025 **Imagination Seminar Series, Sogang University, S.Korea**
Computing cultural taste
- 2025 **Neuroscience of Perception & Action Lab, Italian Institute of Technology, Italy**
Computing cultural taste
- 2025 **Whitehead Lecture Series, Goldsmiths, University of London, UK**
Understanding music in the age of machine learning
- 2024 **Faculty of Music, University of Cambridge, UK**
Understanding music in the age of machine learning
- 2024 **Music Cognition Lab, Princeton University, US**
Global melody and rhythm reveal independent cultural clusters
- 2024 **Music Department, Durham University, UK**
Big data on music, implications and future outlooks
- 2024 **AI Robotics Group, KIST Korea Institute of Science and Technology, S. Korea**
Mechanisms of cultural spread and diversity through individual and population-level music patterns
- 2023 **Cognitive Ethnomusicology Special Interest Group, Bates College, US**
Global Pop: Studying the evolution of pop music across 51 countries since the 1950s
- 2022 **Evolution & Social Cognition Group, Ecole Normale Supérieure, France**
Understanding cultural diversity and spread through large-scale music listening behaviour
- 2022 **CompMusic Lab, Keio University, Japan**
Cross-cultural mood perception in pop songs and its alignment with algorithmic estimates
- 2022 **Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Germany**

- GlobalPOP: Studying the evolution of pop music across 51 countries since the 1950s*
 2022 **Deezer Research**, France
GlobalPOP: Investigating the historical trajectories of popular music around the world
Brain Awareness Week Leipzig, Germany
Without a song or a dance what are we?: Origins of music and how our musical perception is shaped by culture

CONFERENCES

- 2026 **Oral** — Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting (CogSci), Rio, Brazil
 2026 **Oral** — Cultural Evolution Society (CES), Rabat, Morocco
 2026 **Oral** — Intl. Assoc. of Empirical Aesthetics (IAEA), Jena, Germany
 2025 **Oral** — Intl. Soc. for Music Information Retrieval Conf. (ISMIR), Dajeon, S.Korea
 2025 **Oral** — Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC), Sao Paulo, Brazil
 2025 **Poster** — Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting (CogSci), San Francisco, US
 2025 **Oral** — Explaining culture: an interdisciplinary approach, ENS, Paris, France
 2024 **Oral** — Cultural Evolution Society (CES), Durham, UK
 2024 **Oral** — Intl. Assoc. of Empirical Aesthetics (IAEA), Mallorca, Spain
 2023 **Oral** — Computational Humanities Research Conf. (CHR), Paris, France
 2023 **Oral** — Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC), Tokyo, Japan
 2022 **Oral** — Cultural Evolution Society (CES), Aarhus, Denmark
 2022 **Oral** — Systematic Musicology (SysMus), Ghent, Belgium
 2022 **Oral & Poster** — Cognitive Science Society Annual Meeting (CogSci), Toronto, Canada
 2021 **Oral** — Intl. Soc. for Music Information Retrieval Conf. (ISMIR), Virtual
 2021 **Oral** — Intl. Conf. on Music Perception and Cognition (ICMPC), Virtual
 2020 **Poster** — Timbre 2020, Virtual
 2019 **Oral** — Conf. on Interdisciplinary Musicology Embodiment Music, Graz, Austria
 2019 **Poster** — Forum IRCAM Annual Workshop, Paris, France

PRESS HIGHLIGHTS

- 2024 **New Scientist** — ‘Pythagoras was wrong about the maths behind pleasant music’.
<https://www.newscientist.com/article/2419442-pythagoras-was-wrong-about-the-maths-behind-pleasant-music>
 2023 **BBC** — ‘Have your say: Does the weather influence the music you listen to?’.
<https://www.bbc.co.uk/newsround/65457387>
 2023 **PhysOrg** — ‘New research shows how cultural transmission shapes the evolution of music’
<https://phys.org/news/2023-03-cultural-transmission-evolution-music.html>

TEACHING

Supervisions Lok Yan Lam (PhD co-supervisor; current), Farshad Jafari (PhD co-supervisor; current), Robin Blake (Part II Project Supervisor 2025/26; First Class)

Courses

2026, 2027 (planned) **Faculty of Music, University of Cambridge**
 Lent-term MPhil course: ‘Global Musical Tastes in the Age of Big Data’

Tutorials & Lectures

- 2026 **Goldsmiths, University of London**
 A 2-hour class on big data and music, given to MSc Music, Mind, and Brain students
 2025 **Tutorial, International Society for Music Information Retrieval Conference (ISMIR)**

- 3-hour tutorial on 'PsyNet: Collecting Large-Scale Behavioral Datasets for MIR Applications'
- 2024 **Department of Sociology, Seoul National University**
A 2-hour class on computational social science provided to Master's students
- 2021 **Department of Life Science, Leipzig University**
Seminar on deploying massive online experiments using PsyNet

SKILLS

- Language & Software R, Python, Javascript, HTML, SQL, Google BigQuery, AWS, HPC Computing, Gephi, Max MSP
- Development Author of **tptR** R package (<https://github.com/harin-git/tptR>)
Psychoacoustic experiments run on R to determine interindividual differences in timbre perception
- Contributed to **PsyNet** (www.psynet.dev)
A platform for running large-scale online behavioural experiments enabling complex paradigms
- Open Science Along with my publications, I publish all analysis code and data on OSF (<https://osf.io/ecrhs>) and GitHub (<https://github.com/harin-git>)

REFERENCES

- Dr Nori Jacoby** (kj338@cornell.edu)
Assistant Professor, Department of Psychology, Cornell University
- Dr Marc Schönwiesner** (marcs@uni-leipzig.de)
Dean, Faculty of Life Sciences, Leipzig University
- Dr Minsu Park** (mins.park@nyu.edu)
Assistant Professor, Social Research and Public Policy, NYU Abu Dhabi

RANDOM FACTS

I played on the stage of Berghain, Berlin, where I monitored the brain activities of producer EggeEgore in real time, feeding them back into the mix to manipulate the soundscapes and the underlying beats of the live performance. I've released two electronic pop music albums, which are available on major streaming platforms ("Youth" by Harin and "In Dreams" by Computer Hope).